

Cheat Sheet: Files

Duke OLLI Digital Explorers SIG

David Shamlin January 2026

Finder UI Overview

This is the name of the folder you are looking into. This folder is typically referred to as the "current folder" or "working folder".

You can alt-click on the name of the folder to see the path of folders above this folder. If you click the name of a folder in that list, you will see its contents in the pane

The Finder remembers the folders you visit. This pair of folders let's you move through the list of remembered folders. Note these are similar to the "history" icons in browser toolbars.

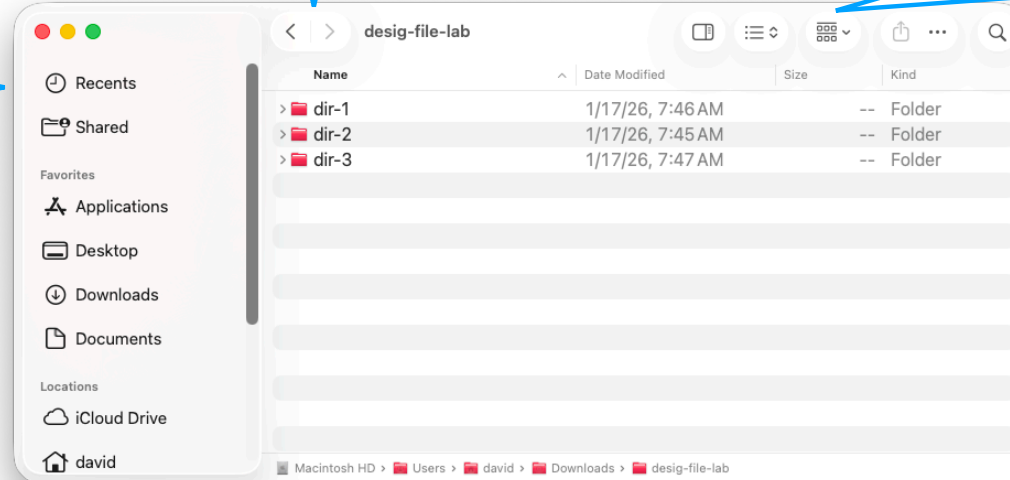
This icon opens/closes the **preview pane**. The preview pane shows you metadata for the currently selected item.

This icon allows you to change how items in the **view pane** appear.

This icon allows you to how items in the **view pane** are sorted and or grouped.

The **sidebar** list commonly used/favorite folders and drives.

There are commands in the View menu to hide and show the sidebar.



This area at the top of the window is called a **toolbar**.

Toolbars tend to contain icons for common features.

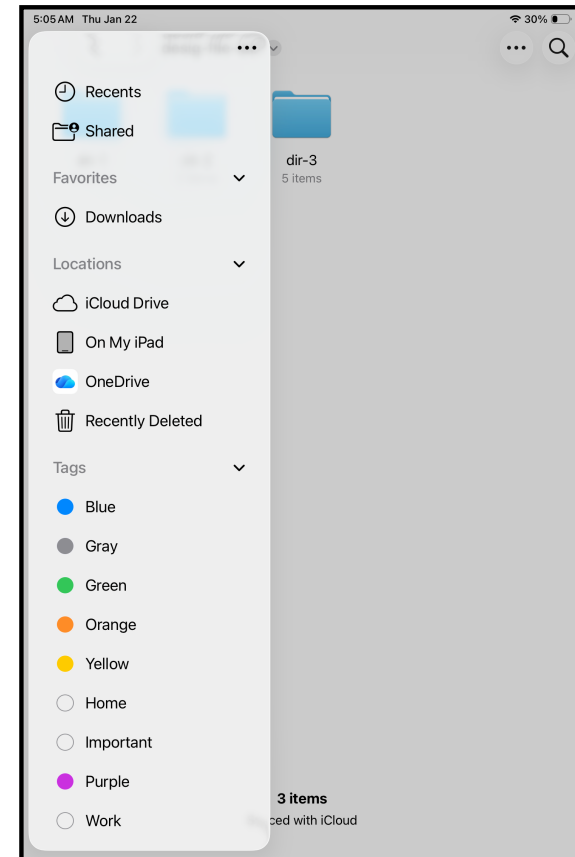
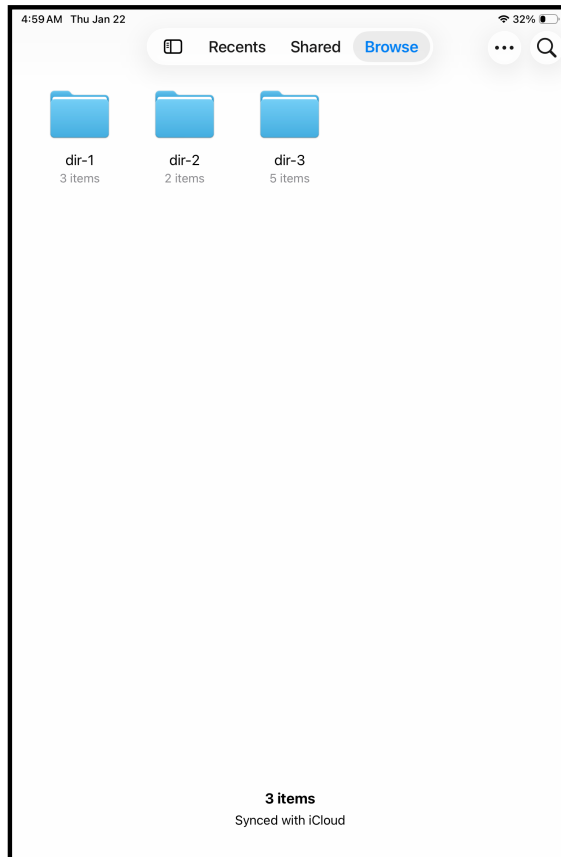
This is the **view pane**. The files/folder that reside in the current folder will be shown here.

You can change how items are shown in this pane using the fifth toolbar icon from the right or using the View menu.

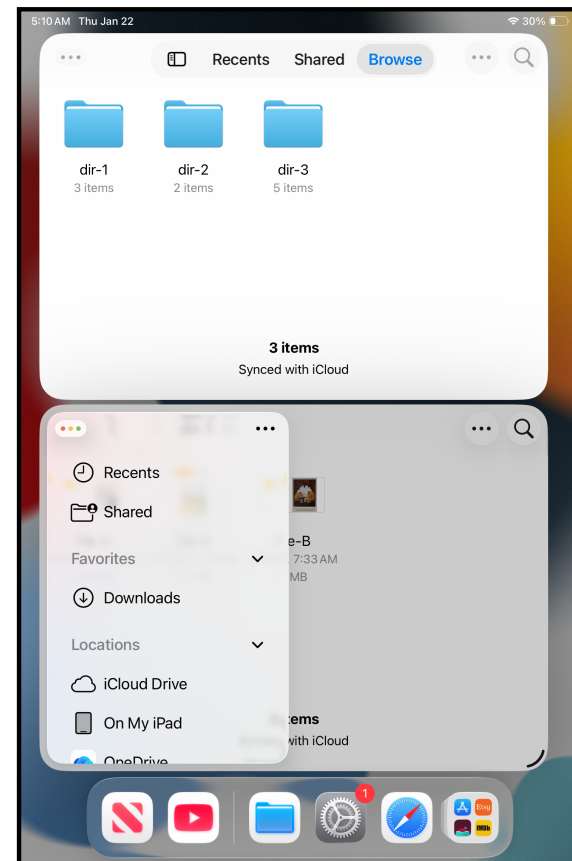
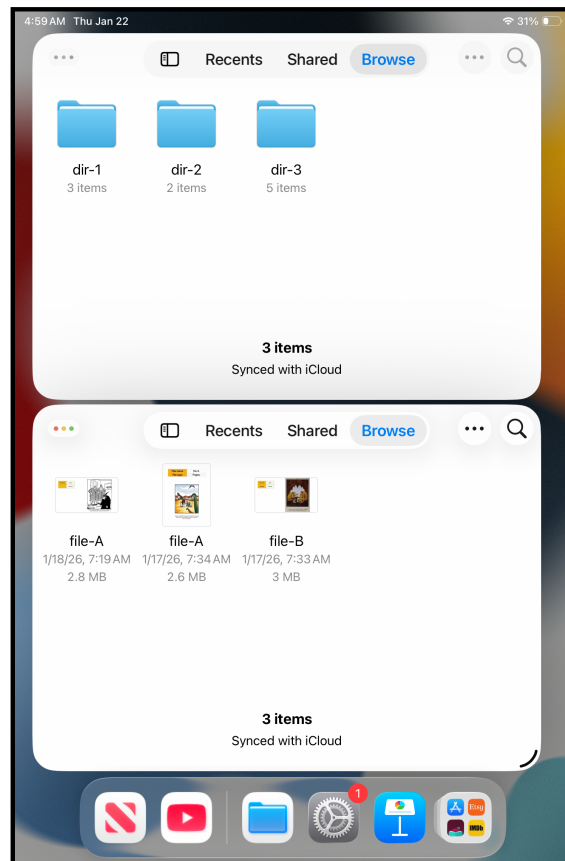
This small pane shows you the paths of objects.

If you have an object in the view pane selected, you will see its path here, otherwise you will see the path of the current folder.

Files UI Overview (“Full Screen Apps” mode)



Files UI Overview (“Windowed Apps” mode)



Standard macOS App Open Dialog

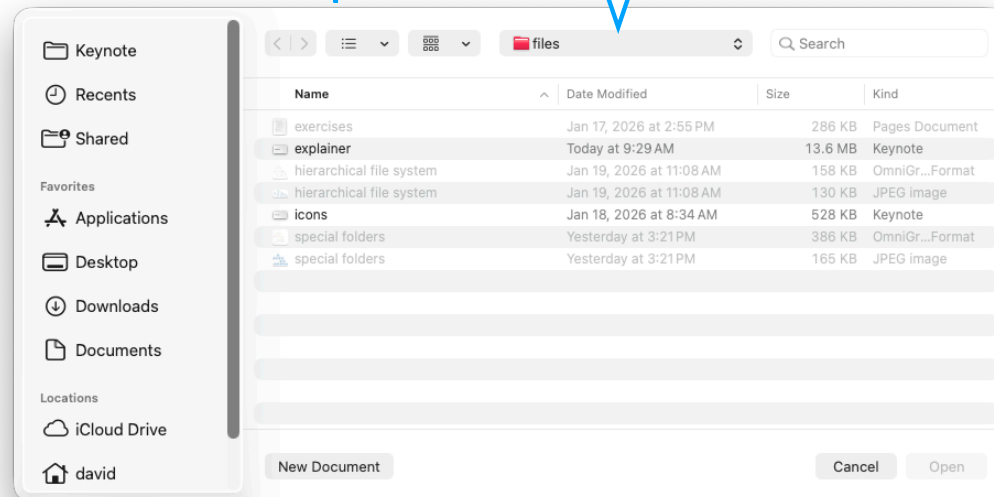


Note the similarities between this dialog and the Finder window. They are nearly the same! The UI elements in this dialog that look similar to UI elements in Finder windows do the same thing/work the same way as they do in Finder.

The Finder window toolbar has a few icons that are not found in the standard app open dialog, but you won't miss them!

This UI element shows the current folder; Finder windows have an UI element that does the same thing but looks a little different.

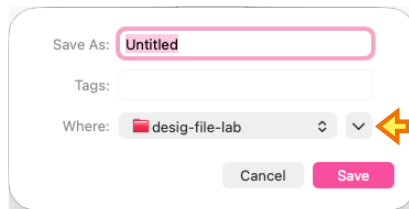
This sidebar contains the same elements as the Finder's sidebar and you use it the same way. While this sidebar in Finder windows can be hidden, it is always visible in the standard app open dialog.



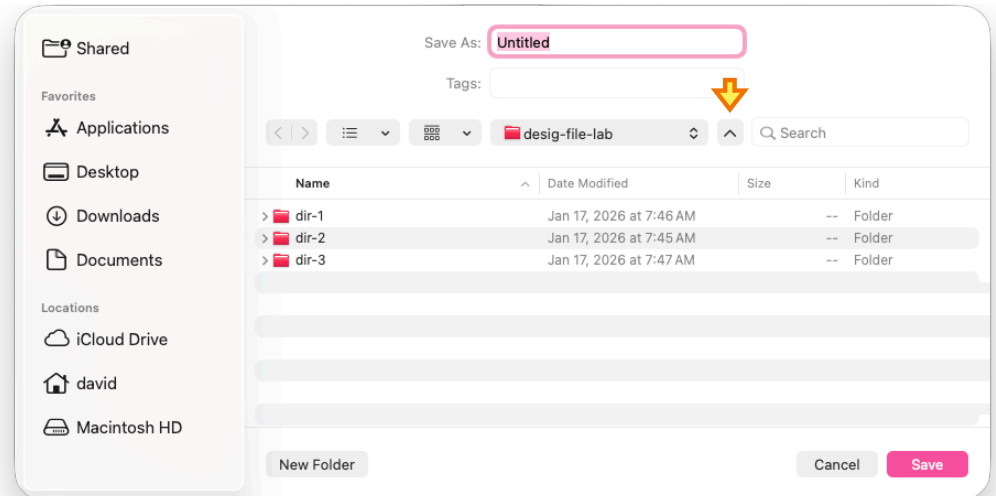
The open dialog differs from a Finder window in this area along the bottom; Finder windows show you the selected file/folder path in this area.

Standard macOS App Save Dialog

Collapsed View



Expanded View



Click the arrow icon (highlighted above with yellow arrows) found immediately to the right of the current folder name to switch between collapsed and expanded views.

Copy *via the file manager*

On macOS	
Menu Bar	1. select item 2. Edit ► Copy 3. Edit ► Paste
Shortcut	1. select item 2. CMD+C 3. CMD+V
Context Menu	1. alt-click on item 2. click Copy 3. alt-click on view pane background 4. select Paste
Context Menu	1. alt-click on item 2. click Duplicate

On iOS	
Context Menu	1. touch and hold item until menu appears 2. tap Copy 3. touch and hold view pane background 4. tap Paste

Note: There is also a "Copy" item on the menu that appears when you tap the ellipsis icon (upper right hand corner). This menu command copies the current folder.

Move *via the file manager*

On macOS	
Menu Bar	1. select item 2. Edit ► Copy 3. Edit ► Paste
Shortcut	1. select item 2. CMD+C 3. CMD+V
Context Menu	1. alt-click on item 2. click Copy 3. alt-click on view pane background 4. select Paste
Context Menu	1. alt-click on item 2. click Duplicate

On iOS	
Context Menu	1. touch and hold item until menu appears 2. tap Move 3. Navigate to the folder you want to place the file in 4. tap the “Move” button

Note: There is also a “Move” item on the menu that appears when you tap the ellipsis icon (upper right hand corner). This menu command moves the current folder.

Rename *via the file manager*

On macOS	
Menu Bar	1. select item 2. File ► Rename
Context Menu	1. alt-click on item 2. click Rename
Shortcut	1. select item 2. press return/enter key 3. type the new name 4. press return/enter key

On iOS	
Context Menu	1. touch and hold item until menu appears 2. tap Rename 3. type the new name you want the file to have 4. tap the return/enter key

Note: There is also a "Rename" item on the menu that appears when you tap the ellipsis icon (upper right hand corner). This menu command renames the current folder.

Delete *via the file manager*

On macOS	
Menu Bar	1. select item 2. File ► Move to trash
Context Menu	1. alt-click on item 2. click Move to trash
Drag and drop	1. press and hold item 2. move mouse to position item on the trash icon in the dock 3. release the mouse button

On iOS	
Context Menu	1. touch and hold item until menu appears 2. tap the Delete item

Open *via the file manager*

On macOS	
Menu Bar	1. select item 2. File ► Open
Context Menu	1. alt-click on item 2. click Open
Shortcut	1. double-click on item

On iOS	
	1. tap on the item